

The same world, twice

How to find things

Open the student hub on your phone or laptop and keep it open all class:
gordonusc.github.io/the-cabinet/ctin290-september-30/CLASSROOM/

The dark menu at the top of every page: **Run of show** (home), **Videos** (the six trailers), **My notes** (where you write), **Board finish** (12:15), **Terms, Rubrics, Class screens**. Amber marks the page you are on.

Today, block by block

10:00 to 10:12**The spine: three worlds that exist twice**

The Last of Us, League and Arcane, Minecraft. And Hamilton, stage onto screen. What does a crossing cost?

10:12 to 10:48**Riot: Awaken, then Arcane**

Same world, two visual languages. Watch both, then three questions.

10:48 to 11:06**The three questions, in writing**

One pair per team. What survived, what was reinvented, what is gone.

11:06 to 11:16**Break**

Ten minutes. Leave the room.

11:16 to 11:46**Minecraft: the game, then the film**

A world you build, adapted into a world you watch. Crossing, or contradiction?

11:46 to 12:15

In-engine cinematography

Clair Obscur and GTA VI. What engines make easy, and what they still make hard.

12:15 to 12:45

Board finish: last hands on it

Count, palette, weakest image out. File due tomorrow, 5 PM.

12:45 to 12:50

Exit ticket

Two lines: one term and where you saw it, one thing you are unsure of.

What you will practice

1. Answer the three questions about one pair from the canon in writing, with the third question argued rather than asserted.
2. Say what an engine makes easy that a camera makes expensive, and one thing engines still make hard, with a shot as evidence.
3. Leave with your mood board counted, its palette checked against the screen, and its weakest image removed.

The three questions

1. What survived the crossing unchanged? 2. What had to be reinvented because the new medium could not carry the original? 3. What is simply gone, and is its absence felt?

The clips

- League of Legends, Awaken (Season 2019 cinematic), 3:28. Photoreal light, painted skin, a world you could almost touch. What is this film for?

- Arcane, official trailer (Netflix), 2:44. What did Arcane gain by abandoning photoreal rendering, and what did it give up?
- Minecraft, official trailer (the game), 1:00. Whose hands are building? Whose choice is every block?
- A Minecraft Movie, official trailer, 2:30. A world whose whole identity is that you built it, adapted into a form where you watch somebody else build it. Crossing, or contradiction?
- Clair Obscur: Expedition 33, launch trailer, 2:22. Lighting, camera and composition, all authored inside the engine. What did the engine make easy that a camera makes expensive?
- Grand Theft Auto VI, Trailer 1, 1:30. Same question, different engine and a different world. What is still hard for an engine to do?

Content notes

Fantasy violence in the Arcane and Clair Obscur trailers at trailer intensity. In the GTA VI trailer: crime imagery, sexualized dancing and suggestive imagery, and spoken profanity is possible. You may look away or step out at any time.

Concepts

Adaptation. The crossing of a world from one medium into another. The useful question is never whether it is faithful. It is what survived unchanged, what had to be reinvented because the new medium could not carry the original, and what is simply gone.

What survived. The part of a world that crosses into the new medium unchanged: a name, a color, a silhouette, a rule, a relationship.

What was reinvented. The part that had to be rebuilt because the new medium cannot carry the original form.

What is gone. The part that simply does not come along, and the honest judgment of whether its absence is felt.

In-engine cinematography. Cinema authored inside a game engine: lighting, camera and composition built in the same tool that runs the game.

Finishing pass. A critique that adds nothing and removes what is weakest: count the images, say the palette, name the weakest image and cut it.

Board finish, 12:15 to 12:45

Count the images out loud. Say the palette, then check the screen. The room names the weakest image; cut it.

Dates

Mood-board file: tomorrow, Thursday October 1, 5 PM Pacific, to Drive. Presentations: Monday October 5, five minutes, everyone speaks. Homework, ungraded: three sentences on one thing your project can only do because it lives in an engine.

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